HEATHER ROD

BLOOMINGTON, IL | RODHEATHER23@GMAIL.COM | 309.808.9719

Innovative communications analyst championing data literacy and user-centric strategy. Proven success applying human-centered design to audience insights, developing advanced analytics dashboards, and pioneering frameworks that drive personalized, transparent employee engagement and transform corporate communication culture.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

COMMUNICATIONS ANALYST, CORPORATE COMMS

05.2024 - Present

STATE FARM | BLOOMINGTON, IL

- Developed Power BI and Adobe Analytics dashboards to enable greater understanding of audiences and content performance, empowering peers to independently and confidently apply data and insights.
- Redesigned catastrophe communication feedback loops using open-response metrics during high-stakes events, resulting in overwhelmingly positive response and increased employee perception of enterprise transparency.
- Researched and co-developed internal channels benchmarking and an effective internal communication framework alongside senior leadership to align with industry best practices.

PUBLIC AFFAIRS COMMUNICATIONS SPECIALIST

07.2023 - 05.2024

STATE FARM | BLOOMINGTON, IL

- Researched and reported for SFnet News and assumed ownership of quarterly reporting for internal channels.
- Applied design thinking to develop comprehensive Audience Communication Profiles, equipping specialists to understand unique audience needs and deliver personalized, relevant messaging.

DIGITAL MANAGER

08.2020 - 07.2023

ILLINOIS SOYBEAN ASSOCIATION | BLOOMINGTON, IL

- Connected 43,000 farmers to the work of the organization through multiple digital channels, pioneering digital marketing and analytics standards and practices among state soybean associations.
- Coordinated, directed, and collaborated with external contractors and internal stakeholders on multiple concurrent organizational and departmental projects, delivering visible value to constituents.
- Launched and nurtured internship program and provided company-wide HR/IT services during leadership vacancies, demonstrating adaptability and accountability through periods of disruption and uncertainty.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE: Digital Coordinator, Support Services Coordinator (ISA, 2019-2020) • HR Recruiter (The Kelly Group, 2018) • Total Rewards Specialist (Pekin Insurance, 2017-2018) • HR Roles (Skill Sprout, 2014-2017) • Business Co-Owner & Manager (Nacho Mama's Grilled Cheese, 2013-2017)

CORE COMPETENCIES

DATA & ANALYTICS:
Power BI, Adobe Analytics, Excel

STRATEGIC SKILLS:
Design Thinking, User Research, Audience Demographics, Sentiment, Measurement

DIGITAL PLATFORMS:
Web & CRM (Drupal, WordPress, SharePoint), Email & Social (Mailchimp, HubSpot, Sprout, Staffbase, Viva Engage)

LEADERSHIP & AFFILIATIONS

PRIDE BUSINESS RESOURCE GROUP

STATE FARM | 07.2023 – PRESENT

- **2026 Engagement Ambassador:** Collaborate with BRG leaders to connect LGBTQ+ employees and allies with each other, the enterprise, and the broader community.
- **2025-2026 Business Pillar Support:** Coordinate content and logistics for quarterly all-member meetings, support virtual events, and develop resources.

EDUCATION

BACHELOR OF ARTS, COMMUNICATION

Eureka College | Eureka, IL CLASS OF 2011